

largest online market in the world and the cheapest data rates, India offers a growing fintech market. However, we need to be mindful of the security of our digital assets and cybersecurity.

Skill development

To turn India's demographic advantage into an economic advantage, training and education must focus on "employable" skills, aligning with future industry demands. All the more so because the Fourth Industrial Revolution and advances in technology are transforming jobs that demand new skills.

By imparting AI skills across the value chain and investing in research and development throughout the workforce, the food processing sector can help India stay at the cutting edge of the value chain.

Elsewhere, too, there have been significant changes. The workplace has begun its transformational journey. Inclusion and diversity will be reflected not only in boardrooms but in all aspects of business.

AI as 'value-added' activity

We are on the cusp of a transformative era in technology. AI and Generative AI have spurred technological innovation. A report by online job portal TeamLease Digital states that India is home to 16% of the global AI talent pool. The adoption of AI in line with the vision for 'Make AI in India' and 'Make AI Work for India' can positively impact people across sectors like agriculture, manufacturing, and healthcare. A report by IT industry association NASSCOM estimates that AI adoption is poised to add \$500 billion to India's GDP by 2025.

Thus, the integration of AI could herald a significant value-added activity. AI—when used in the FMCG sector for sourcing raw materials, customer engagement,

supply chain, product development, logistics, sales, and distribution—can significantly drive business strategy.

However, we should not be completely swayed by techno-optimism. To harness the power of technology for good, it would be imperative to bring accountability and ensure that no one is left behind.

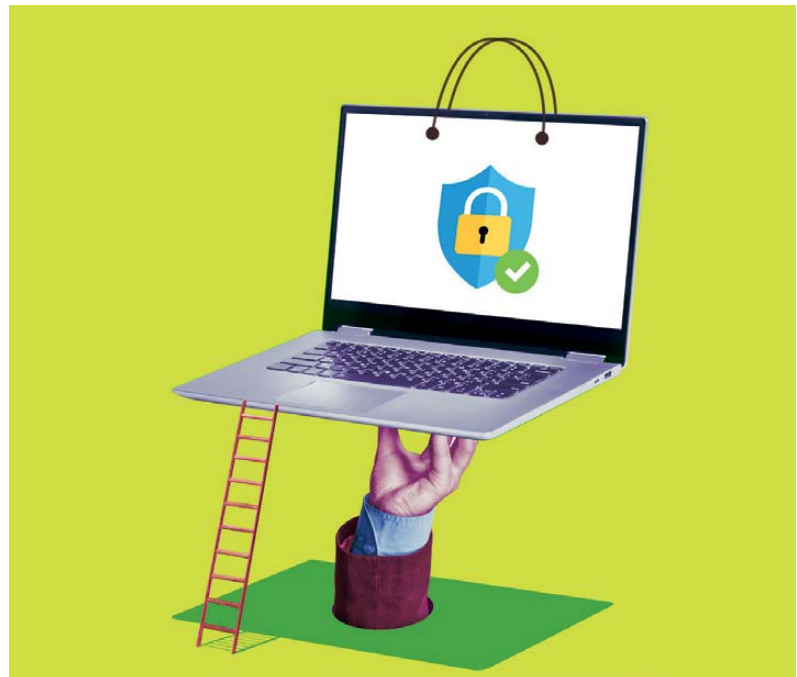
Generative AI creates content that demands judicious execution.

lution, and waste". The recently convened COP28, too, was a step in this direction.

Environmental sustainability must be embedded into business strategies to make responsible choices, create a road map to regularly assess impact, and move with speed to address emissions.

The definition of organisational performance will undergo a paradigm shift in terms of how

ILLUSTRATION BY **RAJ VERMA**



We need to be cognizant that malicious actors can spread fake news, damage reputations, and manipulate public opinion. This requires effective detection, ethical guidelines, and responsible deployment.

A force for good

Climate change is rapidly intensifying. The United Nations Environment Programme is looking to address what it calls the "triple planetary crisis of climate change, nature and biodiversity loss, pol-

we measure progress and value contributions. Moving past the sole focus on financial metrics, organisations will be expected to demonstrate "performance with a purpose". This reflects the zeitgeist of an evolving society. The "new vanguard" would need to balance audacious strides with prudence, seize opportunities, and catch silver linings. **BT**

The author is Chairman and MD of Nestlé India. Views are personal